

Code Editors

HTML pages are not any kind of compiled programs and pages. They are basically text files with tags that are converted into a page by the browser after referring to the HTML standard. So basically, one can create an HTML page using a simple notepad program and then view the page using a browser. The most easy to use HTML page editors and creators available are the WYSIWYG type of Web authoring tools. These software are usually very expensive and therefore not the best bet for new users.

There is, however, another category of Web authoring tools, called code editors, which work the same way as WYSIWYG editors and many of these can be down-

loaded for free from the Internet. The only difference is that they don't show you a live preview of the page that you're currently working on.

Code editors allow you to manually add your own piece of code. They usually have the buttons for creating the elements that you would create on a WYSIWYG editor, but the program adds the particular code to the same page without the preview. However, one can always preview the page using the Preview button that may exist in the software. Quite a few of these code editors have wizards for various themes and sometimes code editors can be as advanced as the WYSIWYG tools.

have any inbuilt image editor, you could use a default external image viewer/editor for editing the images. Adobe GoLive, however, integrated the feature into the software itself, while other software such as Tarantula and Allaire Homesite did not provide an integrated image editor or viewer.

Mapping progress: Creating links for images is something that the more advanced packages provide for mapping images. This means that within the same image, you can create different hotspots or demarcate areas that have different target links.

Allaire Homesite allows image mapping through the Web authoring tool itself, where specific portions of an image can be linked to different parts of the Web page or other external resources. It opens up sub-applications and then you can mark up the areas on the image that you want to create links to. Even in NetObjects, creation of hotspots was quite simple.

Images alternatives: Alternative text for images is a feature that is quite useful if you are browsing using a text-browser such as Lynx, or have disabled images in your browser. This text can be specified in the properties of the image itself. This feature was available in all the software except NetUp.

Most software also come with options of rendering a low-resolution image first; clicking on the low-res photo will take you to the original one. This feature is known as Lower source and was available with all the packages except NetUP and CoolPage.

Dreamweaver offered one of the simplest interfaces to create such lower resolution images.

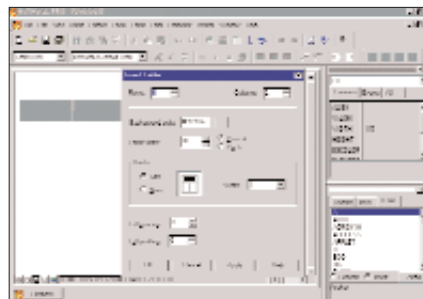
Tabling it right

Tables are at the heart of most Web pages, especially nested tables (tables within tables). Most design errors in Web pages tend to occur in this area, especially in cell padding or cell borders.

NetUp and Cool Page were two software that did not have the table feature at all. Inserting tables in Macromedia Dreamweaver, Namo Editor, Net Object Fusion and HotMetal Pro was really easy and this function was very easy to locate. You could specify the table rows and columns and their width either in pixels or percentages. All of these also supported the creation of nested tables.

We could change the background colours of all the tables that we created, but only Dreamweaver provided for creation of headers for tables and a whole lot of parameters for cells.

Creating tables was the easiest in

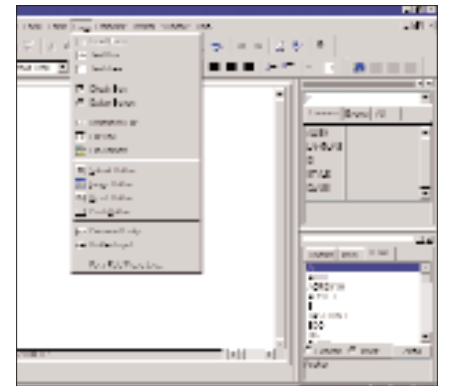


Creating tables and nested tables in HotMetal Pro is a simple task

Microsoft FrontPage as you could just click on the Tables' icon and drag the mouse to create how many ever number of columns and rows that you wanted on the page.

Moving in formation

Most Web sites will require some dynamic form elements on the page, such as Push buttons (for Submit and Reset options generally), drop-down boxes (while selecting items such as date of birth), text boxes (comments field or name field), radio buttons (to specify whether male or female), check boxes (to tick off items that are of interest), etc.



Creating Form elements in HotMetal Pro

Well, in NetUP and CoolPage we didn't have to bother at all, since these packages didn't have the Forms option. This was a major drawback. In such cases, you would have no option but to manually code if you wanted to use forms. The other software had form templates and they were easily accessible at the click of a button.

The form creation option in HotMetal Pro is a special option on the menu bar that allows you to create a form element. The other software that allows you to insert forms with ease is Macromedia Dreamweaver, where the Insert option on the menu bar has the options for inserting the form elements.

More on the feature side

Ah! If you start really working on your Web site, there's no stopping on the number of items that you would require. But, basics first! You need to upload your files to a Web server first, so if your software allows you to upload the Web pages, then you can give a miss to the FTP client.

One of the main additional features that we found in GoLive was the synchronizing feature, wherein you could match